

Did you know that children of divorce are far more likely to get a divorce themselves? Daughters of divorced parents have a 60 percent higher divorce rate than daughters whose parents stayed together, and sons have a 35 percent higher divorce rate. Those are seriously sad statistics.

You can't micromanage your child's love life, but you *can* put structures in place to preemptively protect their financial dynasties. James Laureys, the intern we met in [chapter 11](#), is a recipient of this kind of protection. His mother went through a long and costly divorce. Determined to save her son from the same fate, she put a condition in her will that in order for James to receive any inheritance, he had to sign a prenuptial agreement with his partner before getting married. It took the pressure off her son to have a difficult conversation, and he could explain to his prospective wife that this wasn't *his* idea, but his mom's final wish! How could she argue with that?

What a fantastic gift from a brilliant financial strategist. James's mother learned from experience, and in so doing, she saved her son a ton of financial and emotional heartbreak down the line. What a beautiful way to pass along a financial legacy and to ensure that it gets into the right hands.

DEBUNKING FOUR END-OF-MARRIAGE MYTHS

In my circles, I meet a lot of smart and interesting people. Yet I am always surprised by how many intelligent men and women cling to certain myths. In no area are these myths more prevalent than on the topics of divorce and separation. Getting a divorce is hard enough without having to sort through lies and misinformation. Here are the three most common myths I hear—and the actual truths behind them.